

Reporting Verbs Used with All Forms of Optative Sentences

प्रत्यक्ष तथा अप्रत्यक्ष कथनमा Optative Sentences का Reporting Verbs

An **optative sentence** expresses a **wish, prayer, blessing, curse, hope, desire, or good/bad intention**.

Common markers include:

- . May...!
- . May God...!
- . Would that...!
- . If only...!
- . Long live...!
- . Heaven help...!
- . God bless...!
- . May you...!
- . May you never...!

1. Wish — इच्छा / कामना

When someone expresses an ordinary wish or desire.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
wished	इच्छा/कामना गरे
desired	इच्छा गरे
expressed a wish	इच्छा व्यक्त गरे
longed	तीव्र इच्छा गरे

Example

Direct: He said, “May I succeed!”

Indirect: He wished that he might succeed.

Nepali: उसले आफू सफल होस् भनेर कामना गर्‍यो।

2. Good Wish — शुभकामना

Used when the speaker wishes something good for another person.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
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wished	शुभकामना दिए
bestowed good wishes on	शुभकामना दिए
expressed good wishes	शुभकामना व्यक्त गरे

Example

Direct: She said to me, “May you succeed in life!”

Indirect: She **wished that I might succeed** in life.

Nepali: उनले म जीवनमा सफल होऊँ भनेर शुभकामना दिइन्।

3. Blessing — आशीर्वाद

When an elder, parent, teacher, priest, or respected person wishes someone well.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
blessed	आशीर्वाद दिए
prayed for	प्रार्थना गरे

wished	शुभकामना दिए
invoked blessings upon	आशीर्वादको कामना गरे

Example

Direct: The grandmother said, “May God bless you!”

Indirect: The grandmother **blessed me and prayed that God might bless me.**

Nepali: हजुरआमाले मलाई आशीर्वाद दिँदै भगवान्ले मेरो कल्याण गरून् भनेर प्रार्थना गरिन्।

Another example

Direct: Father said to his son, “May you live long!”

Indirect: Father **blessed his son that he might live long.**

In natural English, **blessed his son and wished that he might live long** is often smoother than *blessed him that...*

4. Prayer — प्रार्थना

When the wish is addressed to God or a divine power.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
prayed	प्रार्थना गरे
prayed to God	भगवान्सँग प्रार्थना गरे
invoked	आह्वान/प्रार्थना गरे
beseached	विन्तीपूर्वक प्रार्थना गरे
entreated	हार्दिक विन्ती गरे

Example

Direct: He said, “May God help the poor!”

Indirect: He **prayed that God might help** the poor.

Nepali: उसले भगवान्‌ले गरिबहरूलाई सहायता गरून् भनेर प्रार्थना गर्‍यो।

5. Curse — श्राप / अभिशाप

When someone wishes something bad to happen to another person.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
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cursed	श्राप दिए
invoked a curse on	श्राप दिए/श्रापको आह्वान गरे
wished evil upon	नराम्रो होस् भनेर कामना गरे

Example

Direct: He said, “May you suffer for your deeds!”

Indirect: He **cursed him that he might suffer** for his deeds.

More natural:

He **cursed him and wished that he might suffer** for his deeds.

Nepali: उसले उसलाई श्राप दिँदै आफ्ना कर्मको दुःख भोगोस् भनेर कामना गर्‍यो।

6. Bad Wish — नराम्रो कामना

A speaker may express a negative wish without it necessarily being a formal curse.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
wished evil upon	नराम्रो होस् भनेर कामना गरे
wished harm upon	हानि होस् भनेर कामना गरे
cursed	श्राप दिए
expressed a bad wish	नराम्रो इच्छा व्यक्त गरे

Example

Direct: He said, “May he never prosper!”

Indirect: He wished that he might never prosper.

If the intention is clearly malicious:

He cursed him and wished that he might never prosper.

7. Hope — आशा

Some optative sentences express a desired future outcome.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
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hoped	आशा गरे
wished	कामना गरे
desired	इच्छा गरे
looked forward to	आशापूर्वक प्रतीक्षा गरे

Example

Direct: He said, “May everything go well!”

Indirect: He **hoped** that everything might go well.

Nepali: उसले सबै कुरा राम्रो होस् भनेर आशा गर्‍यो।

8. Expressing a Strong Desire — तीव्र इच्छा

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
desired	तीव्र इच्छा गरे
wished	कामना गरे

longed	तीव्र इच्छा गरे
yearned	उत्कट इच्छा गरे
craved	तीव्र इच्छा गरे

Example

Direct: She said, “If only I could meet my old friend!”

Indirect: She **wished that she could meet** her old friend.

9. Regretful Wish — पश्चात्तापयुक्त इच्छा

This is often expressed with **Would that...!** or **If only...!**

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
wished	कामना गरे
regretted	पछुतो गरे
expressed a regretful wish	पश्चात्तापयुक्त इच्छा व्यक्त गरे

Example

Direct: He said, “If only I had studied harder!”

Indirect: He **wished that he had studied** harder.

Nepali: उसले अझ मेहनत गरेर पढेको भए हुन्थ्यो भनेर पछुतो गऱ्यो।

10. Impossible / Unreal Wish — असम्भव वा काल्पनिक इच्छा

Reporting Verb Nepali Meaning

wished इच्छा/कामना गरे

longed तीव्र इच्छा गरे

dreamed of कल्पना/सपना देखे

Example

Direct: He said, “Would that I were rich!”

Indirect: He **wished that he were rich.**

Nepali: उसले आफू धनी भएको भए हुन्थ्यो भनेर इच्छा गऱ्यो।

11. “Long Live...” — दीर्घायु/जयकामना

Long live + person/nation/institution expresses a strong wish for continued life, success, or existence.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
wished	शुभकामना दिए
expressed the wish that...	...को कामना व्यक्त गरे
prayed for the long life of...	दीर्घायुको प्रार्थना गरे

Example

Direct: The people said, “Long live our King!”

Indirect: The people wished that their King might live long.

Nepali: जनताले आफ्ना राजाको दीर्घायुको कामना गरे।

12. “May God...” — भगवान्सँग सम्बन्धित कामना

Expression	Reporting Verb
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May God bless you!	blessed / prayed
May God help you!	prayed
May God protect you!	prayed
May God forgive him!	prayed
May God grant your wish!	prayed

Example

Direct: Mother said, “May God protect you!”

Indirect: Mother **prayed that God might protect** me.

13. “Heaven Help...” — दैवी सहायता/रक्षा

Heaven help him! expresses a strong wish or warning that divine help may come.

Reporting verbs

- **prayed**
- **hoped**
- **wished**
- **invoked divine help**

Example

Direct: He said, “Heaven help us!”

Indirect: He **prayed that Heaven might help** them.

14. “God Bless...” — आशीर्वाद

Example

Direct: The old man said, “God bless you!”

Indirect: The old man **blessed me and prayed that God might bless** me.

Nepali: वृद्ध मानिसले मलाई आशीर्वाद दिँदै भगवान्‌ले मेरो कल्याण गरून्
भनेर प्रार्थना गरे।

15. Expressing a Hopeful Wish — आशावादी कामना

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
hoped	आशा गरे

wished	कामना गरे
prayed	प्रार्थना गरे
desired	इच्छा गरे

Example

Direct: The students said, “May we pass the examination!”

Indirect: The students **hoped that they might pass** the examination.

16. Farewell / Good-Fortune Wish — बिदाइ वा शुभकामना

Some expressions at parting function as optative wishes.

Expression	Reporting Verb
“May you have a safe journey!”	wished
“May you succeed!”	wished
“Have a happy life!”	wished
“May you be happy!”	wished

Example

Direct: He said to me, “May you have a safe journey!”

Indirect: He **wished me a safe journey.**

★ **Master List of Optative Reporting Verbs**

Meaning	Suitable Reporting Verbs	Nepali
Wish	wished, desired, longed	इच्छा/कामना गरे
Good wish	wished, expressed good wishes	शुभकामना दिए
Blessing	blessed, prayed	आशीर्वाद दिए/प्रार्थना गरे
Prayer	prayed, beseeched, entreated	प्रार्थना/विन्ती गरे
Curse	cursed, wished evil upon	श्राप दिए
Bad wish	wished harm/evil upon, cursed	नराम्रो कामना/श्राप दिए
Hope	hoped, wished	आशा/कामना गरे
Strong desire	desired, longed, yearned	तीव्र इच्छा गरे

Regretful wish	wished, regretted	पछुतोयुक्त इच्छा गरे
Unreal wish	wished, dreamed of	काल्पनिक इच्छा गरे
Long-life wish	wished, prayed for long life	दीर्घायुको कामना गरे
Divine help	prayed, invoked	भगवान्सँग प्रार्थना गरे
Good fortune	wished, prayed	शुभकामना दिए

Important Structures in Indirect Speech

1. General Wish

Subject + wished + that + subject + might + V1

“May you succeed!”

→ He wished that I might succeed.

2. Prayer

Subject + prayed + that + subject + might + V1

“May God help you!”

→ He prayed that God might help me.

3. Blessing

Subject + blessed + object + and wished/prayed that + clause

“May you live long!”

→ The grandmother **blessed me and wished that I might live long.**

4. Curse

Subject + cursed + object + and wished that + subject + might + V1

“May you suffer!”

→ He **cursed him and wished that he might suffer.**

5. Hope

Subject + hoped + that + subject + might/would + V1

“May everything be fine!”

→ She **hoped that everything might be fine.**

6. “Long live...!”

Subject + wished/prayed that + subject + might live long

“Long live our country!”

→ They **wished that their country might live long.**

★ Golden Rule for Optative Sentences

Do not use “ordered”, “asked”, or “told” simply because the sentence is in direct speech. Identify the type of wish first.

May you succeed! → wished

May God help us! → prayed

May God bless you! → blessed/prayed

May you suffer! → cursed

May everything go well! → hoped/wished

If only I had wings! → wished

Long live Nepal! → wished/prayed for the long life of Nepal

This gives you the complete meaning-based system: Wish → Wished | Prayer → Prayed | Blessing → Blessed | Curse → Cursed | Hope → Hoped | Strong Desire → Desired/Longed | Regret → Wished/Regretted.